ALPACA

Vicugna pacos

Think About This

If your ears could turn to catch every tiny

What can it see, hear, or feel?

Tall ears turn toward sounds, wide eyes spot movement on open slopes, and its nose knows the herd.

Where does it live — and why?

It lives on cold mountain grasslands very high up, where the herd shares warmth and safety.

How does it send messages?

It hums quietly to its herd, gives a sharp alarm call, and can spit if crowded too close.

What does it do when something changes?

When alarmed, the whole herd groups tightly together and watches before deciding to move.

How does it learn?

A baby alpaca stays close to its mother, copies her grazing, and learns alarm signals from adults.

How does it have babies?

A mother has one baby after about eleven months, and it stands within an hour of birth.

What are its limits?

Sudden cold or storms high in the mountains can drive the herd down to lower ground fast.

What does this teach us?

Its thick coat traps warm air — a quiet example of environment shaping design.